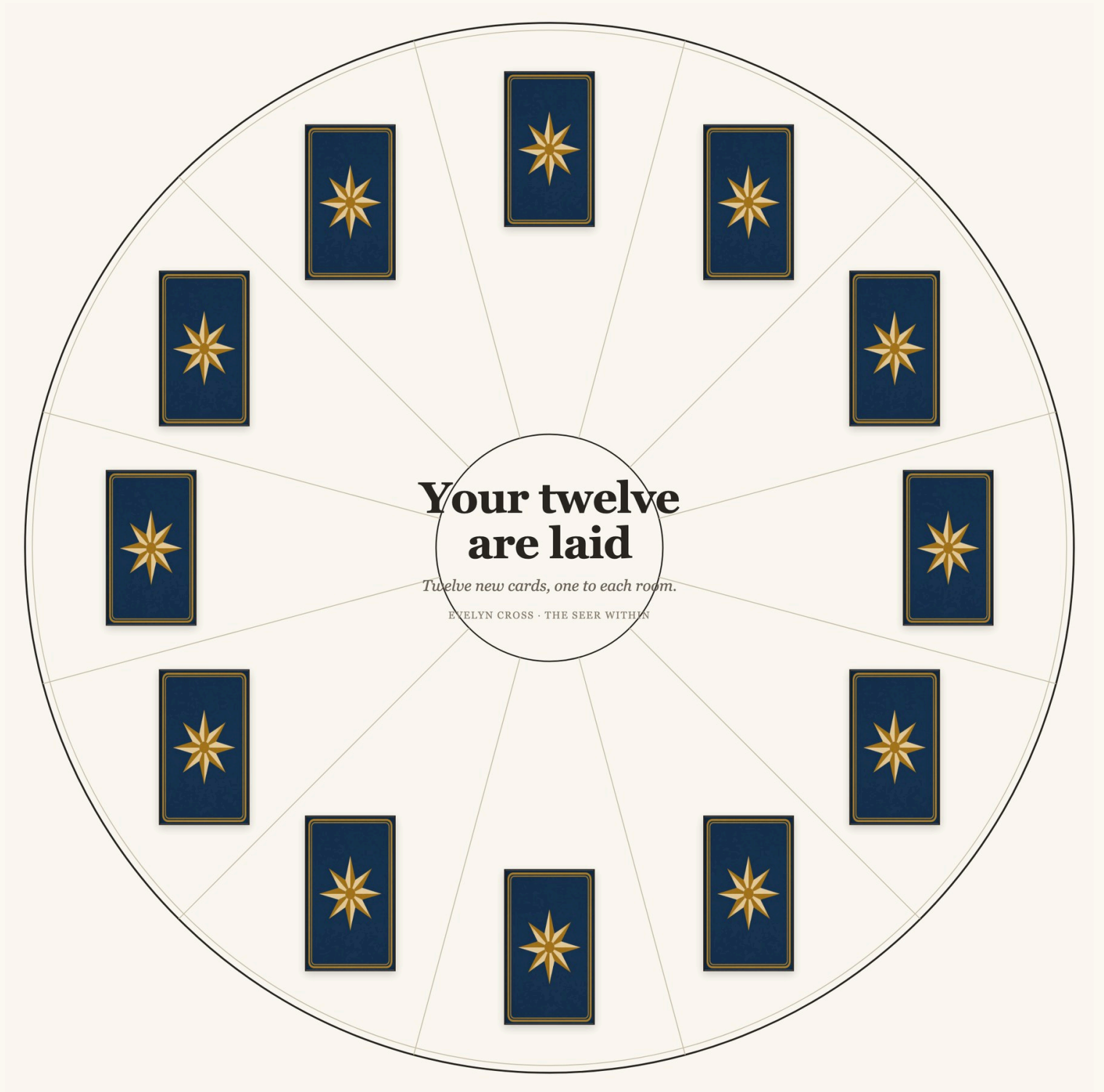




Laid for **Sarah** · 7 September 2026

YOUR TWELVE, AS THEY WERE LAID

A house is a room of a life. The wheel has twelve of them, and one card was laid in each — it is the oldest spread there is for reading a whole life rather than a single question.

The rooms come in **six pairs**, each one facing the room across the wheel from it: what you own faces what reaches you through other people, home faces your standing, romance faces your circle. Where a room below sends you across to another, that pairing is why.

- 1** **yourself** ↔ 7 *the Sun*
how you meet the world, and what starts with you
- 2** **what you own** ↔ 8 *Temperance*
money, and the things that are genuinely yours
- 3** **what you say, and who you say it to** ↔ 9 *the Hanged Man*
conversations, messages, and the thing you rehearse and never send
- 4** **home, and what you came from** ↔ 10 *the Hermit*
the house you live in, and the one you were raised in
- 5** **romance, and what delights you** ↔ 11 *the Wheel of Fortune*
attraction and pleasure — the beginning of things, before anything is settled
- 6** **work, health, the daily grind** ↔ 12 *the Magician*
the ordinary week: the job, the body, the routine you repeat
- 7** **who you are bound to** ↔ 1 *the High Priestess*
your partner, or whoever you are tied to whether or not it is called that
- 8** **what is hidden, and what comes through others** ↔ 2 *the Fool*
what reaches you through somebody else's hands — money, news, a decision made elsewhere
- 9** **what you believe** ↔ 3 *the Hierophant*
what you take to be true about how life works
- 10** **your standing** ↔ 4 *the Empress*
how you are seen, and by the people whose opinion counts
- 11** **your circle** ↔ 5 *the Devil*
your friends, and who actually turns up
- 12** **what is being kept from you** ↔ 6 *Judgment*
what is real and close, and not visible from where you are standing

The pair marker ↔ points to the room across the wheel. Nothing to learn — it is there so a line that sends you to another room makes sense when it does.

I laid your twelve last night, gone eleven, at the kitchen table with the lamp pulled down close and the rain going.

Two of them came down facing each other across the cloth, and I sat back when they did.

Temperance in your second house. The Fool in your eighth. On its own neither one tells me which door your money walks in by. Set opposite each other, they split it clean.

One of the two comes in through your own hands. The other arrives in somebody's mouth. That is the thing I told you I could not yet see, and I can see it now.

The draw is a good one, dear. I will say that flat, before you read a single line of it.

It is hard in one place only, and that place is your seventh house and your twelfth, which are the same man.

The next two months are the window. Every card below runs on it, so no room has to invent one of its own.

Inside those two months your life happens mainly in three rooms — the fifth, the seventh and the twelfth. The other nine are the ground those three stand on, and I have read every one of them the same way I read those.

All twelve are trumps because I said they would be. No minors for a first draw like yours. It is the heaviest reading I do, it took me the whole of the night, and I do not lay it for everyone who writes.

What the letter left open, these close. Each answer stands in the room that holds it, and I have not carried any of them up here to save you the walk.

One more thing before you begin.

You paid a stranger to tell you about your own life, and some part of you filed that under weakness. Take it back out of the file. Nothing on this table is an accusation, and wanting to know is not the same as being lost.

And read all twelve before you decide what they say. One room will promise you ease and the next will ask you for work. That is the arrangement, not a contradiction — no life reads consistent either.

yourself

The cosmos has guided your choice to the Sun, a card of being seen plainly



THE SUN

*seen plainly, in daylight, nothing to
work out*

The naked child mounted on a white horse and displaying a red standard has been mentioned already as the better symbolism connected with this card. It is the destiny of the Supernatural East and the great and holy light which goes before the endless procession of humanity, coming out from the walled garden of the sensitive life and passing on the journey home. The card signifies, therefore, the transit from the manifest light of this world, represented by the glorious sun of earth, to the light of the world to come, which goes before aspiration and is typified by the heart of a child. The sun is that of consciousness in the spirit—the direct as the antithesis of the reflected light. The characteristic type of humanity has become a little child therein.

A. E. WAITE, *THE PICTORIAL KEY TO THE TAROT*, 1911

Four sunflowers stand above a grey wall, heads up over the top of it — taller than that wall was ever built to allow. They came up where they were planted and got over it anyway. Warm, plain, easy to read, and further along than the people near you have bothered to notice.

The child on the white horse is already out in front of that wall, bareback, both arms open, the red flag streaming sideways. Nothing about you is hidden at the moment.

Which is why your seventh house matters here. Bound to someone, you go quiet — you hint, you wait to be asked, you let him guess. Alone you are in full daylight. Those are not the same

woman, and I won't pretend they are.

So stop translating yourself. Say the plain sentence to him this month, unsoftened.

You already decided you were done pretending you didn't mind.

HOUSE 2

what you own

The celestial wisdom has guided your selection to Temperance, a card of two sums becoming one



TEMPERANCE

*two things becoming one, at the
speed of a season*

A winged angel, with the sign of the sun upon his forehead and on his breast the square and triangle of the septenary. I speak of him in the masculine sense, but the figure is neither male nor female. It is held to be pouring the essences of life from chalice to chalice. It has one foot upon the earth and one upon waters. A direct path goes up to certain heights on the verge of the horizon, and above there is a great light, through which a crown is seen vaguely. Hereof is some part of the Secret of Eternal Life. It is called Temperance fantastically, because, when the rule of it obtains in our consciousness, it tempers, combines and harmonises the psychic and material natures.

A. E. WAITE, *THE PICTORIAL KEY TO THE TAROT*, 1911

One foot is in the pool, ankle-deep, and the other stays flat on the bank beside the yellow flowers. She has not gone in and she has not stepped out. Both are held at once, deliberately.

Your money is being kept the same way. Two small amounts, apart — one you earned, one still owed to you.

That is the door the first windfall comes through, dear. Not a stranger, not a prize, not an inheritance. Money already in your name, in two places, added up and spent at last as one thing.

You will know it by the count. Two cups, one held higher than the other, and the water crossing between them — one sum pours into the second, and the total is larger than you have been assuming.

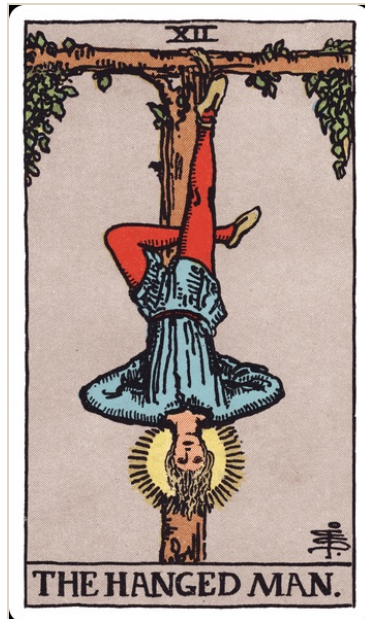
The Fool in your eighth stands barefoot with nothing arranged for him. No other hands are bringing you this one. Yours are.

Which of the two have you never written down?

HOUSE 3

what you say, and who you say it to

The cosmic alignment has guided your choice to the Hanged Man, a card of a silence you chose yourself



THE HANGED MAN

*a wait you agreed to, paid for in
time*

The gallows from which he is suspended forms a Tau cross, while the figure—from the position of the legs—forms a fylfot cross. There is a nimbus about the head of the seeming martyr. It should be noted (1) that the tree of sacrifice is living wood, with leaves thereon; (2) that the face expresses deep entrancement, not suffering; (3) that the figure, as a whole, suggests life in suspension, but life and not death. It is a card of profound significance, but all the significance is veiled. It has been called falsely a card of martyrdom, a card of prudence, a card of the Great Work, a card of duty. I will say very simply on my own part that it expresses the relation, in one of its aspects, between the Divine and the Universe.

A. E. WAITE, *THE PICTORIAL KEY TO THE TAROT*, 1911

His hands are behind his back, out of sight, elbows pushed out to either side. Nobody tied those. He put them there himself.

The message you have written and not sent is that same gesture. You are keeping your own hands out of it deliberately, and the quiet is costing you time you can feel going.

The Hierophant in your ninth is why. You hold a rule you have never said out loud — that whoever speaks first has handed something over. You would not defend that sentence to me, dear, but you obey it every time you close the phone.

So this is not shyness. It is a rule, and you are the one enforcing it on yourself.

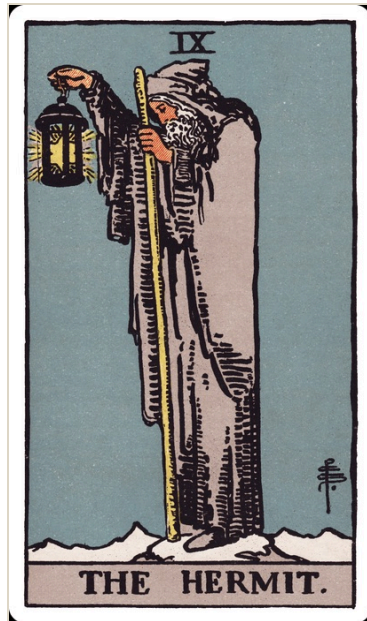
What hangs there does not rot. The gallows is living wood, small green leaves pushing out of it, and you are being paid in a clearer view of him.

Nothing reaches him while you hang.

HOUSE 4

home, and what you came from

Your choice has been guided to the Hermit, a card of managing alone, by habit



THE HERMIT

*gone up alone on purpose, and
holding the light*

The variation from the conventional models in this card is only that the lamp is not enveloped partially in the mantle of its bearer, who blends the idea of the Ancient of Days with the Light of the World. It is a star which shines in the lantern. I have said that this is a card of attainment, and to extend this conception the figure is seen holding up his beacon on an eminence. Therefore the Hermit is not a wise man in search of truth and justice; nor is he an especial example of experience. His beacon intimates that "where I am, you also may be." It is a card which is understood quite incorrectly when it is connected with the idea of occult isolation.

A. E. WAITE, *THE PICTORIAL KEY TO THE TAROT*, 1911

The lamp is held out at shoulder height, well away from his body, a six-pointed star burning inside the glass. His cloak falls clear of it — not one fold of grey drifting near the flame. He is careful with that light, and he is careful with it by himself.

That is the house you came out of. Nothing was asked for in it. Things were handled quietly and reported afterwards, already done.

You have caught yourself at this and decided it was only competence. It is not. You inherited it, and you are still running your rooms on it.

The Empress in your tenth has you full-handed in public — feeding people, easy with them, generous where you are seen. Indoors you carry the whole thing alone and mention it to nobody. The public room is being paid for out of the private one.

I won't call that strength, dear.

This month, ask one person into your house and give them something to carry out of it.

Nothing arrives at a house run that way. It cannot get in the door. Which is what makes your fifth house so strange, because something arrives anyway, unasked for and unarranged.

romance, and what delights you

The cosmic forces have guided your selection to the Wheel of Fortune, a card of the turn you did not ask for



THE WHEEL OF FORTUNE

a change that comes from outside
and does not ask

I have presented Typhon in his serpent form. The four Living Creatures of Ezekiel occupy the angles of the card. The symbolic picture stands for the perpetual motion of a fluidic universe and for the flux of human life. The Sphinx is the equilibrium therein. The transliteration of Taro as Rota is inscribed on the wheel, counterchanged with the letters of the Divine Name—to shew that Providence is implied through all. But this is the Divine intention within, and the similar intention without is exemplified by the four Living Creatures. Sometimes the sphinx is represented couchant on a pedestal above, which defrauds the symbolism by stultifying the essential idea of stability amidst movement. Behind the general notion expressed in the symbol there lies the denial of chance and the fatality which is implied therein.

A. E. WAITE, *THE PICTORIAL KEY TO THE TAROT*, 1911

The sphinx lies flat along the top of the wheel, sword held level across its body, and it never moves with the rim. Under it a snake goes down one side and a dog-headed figure climbs the other. Everything turns except the thing on top.

The High Priestess sits veiled in your seventh, saying nothing. So there is no one there to grow warmer toward you, and I won't hand you a renewal that does not exist.

Yours arrives instead. Your twin flame, in the third week from the day you read this — I can date this one room because an arrival is an event, and events land on a day.

You already know him. The Devil in your eleventh keeps him inside your own circle. He will be mid-errand, on his way to somebody else, and he will stop longer than the errand allows.

Arriving and being known are two separate days, dear.

You wait until you are alone in the car to say the sentence out loud.

Leave this room as it stands and he finishes the errand, and you say it to the windscreen again.

work, health, the daily grind

Your choice fell on the Magician, a card of tools already on your table



THE MAGICIAN

*you already have what the job
needs*

A youthful figure in the robe of a magician, having the countenance of divine Apollo. Above his head is the mysterious sign of the Holy Spirit, the sign of life, forming the figure 8 in a horizontal position. About his waist is a serpent-cincture, the serpent appearing to devour its own tail. In the Magician's right hand is a wand raised towards heaven, while the left hand is pointing to the earth. This dual sign shews the descent of grace, virtue and light, drawn from things above and derived to things below. On the table in front of the Magician are the symbols of the four Tarot suits, signifying the elements of natural life. Beneath are roses and lilies, the flos campi and lilium convallium, changed into garden flowers, to shew the culture of aspiration.

A. E. WAITE, *THE PICTORIAL KEY TO THE TAROT*, 1911

The snake at his waist has no buckle. It holds itself shut by biting its own tail, and the man inside it is fed by nothing but his own hands.

Your working week runs the same way, and it always has. Cup, coin, sword, wand — four things laid out, and not one of them is missing from your table.

You carried someone else's part through a bad stretch and never once said whose it was. That was the right call and I will not let it go unsaid.

But Judgment stands in your twelfth. People are weighing you where you cannot hear it, and what they are weighing is this ordinary week.

So do what the picture does. One hand up, one hand down, the whole line visible.

Say out loud who did which piece this month — the table is already laid, dear, and nothing on it lifts itself.

HOUSE 7

who you are bound to

Your choice has fallen on the High Priestess, a card of what is known and not said



THE HIGH PRIESTESS

*something known and not yet said
out loud*

She has the lunar crescent at her feet, a horned diadem on her head, with a globe in the middle place, and a large solar cross on her breast. The scroll in her hands is inscribed with the word TORA. It is partly covered by her mantle, to shew that some things are implied and some spoken. She is seated between the white and black pillars of the mystic Temple, and the veil of the Temple is behind her: it is embroidered with palms and pomegranates. The vestments are flowing and gauzy, and the mantle suggests light—a shimmering radiance. She is really the Secret Church, the House which is of God and man. She is the spiritual Bride and Mother. She is, in fine, the Queen of the borrowed light.

A. E. WAITE, *THE PICTORIAL KEY TO THE TAROT*, 1911

The crescent lies flat at her feet, horns up, and the hem of her robe has come down over part of it. Her own light is under her clothing, and she sits there anyway.

There is a price still running in this room. You are tied to a man who has never been told the plain thing, and you have named that waiting loyalty.

It is not loyalty. The scroll is in her hands the entire time — she knows, dear, and she has chosen the pace herself.

He is keeping something back as well. I won't guess at what, and I won't invent it to fill the space.

If the quiet here gets taken for patience and left alone, he says his plain thing to someone else first — and you hear it from her, kindly, long after.

Her robe runs down into the water at the bottom edge, and the join does not show. Nothing marks where she stops and the water starts.

So the seventh is the room where you are paying. The eighth is the room where you are paid, and not by him.

HOUSE 8

what is hidden, and what comes through others

The cosmos has turned your hand to the Fool, a card of the gift already in her hand



THE FOOL

*a step taken before you can see
where it lands*

With light step, as if earth and its trammels had little power to restrain him, a young man in gorgeous vestments pauses at the brink of a precipice; he surveys the blue distance before him—its expanse of sky rather than the prospect below. His act of eager walking is still indicated, though he is stationary at the given moment; his dog is still bounding. The edge which opens on the depth has no terror; it is as if angels were waiting to uphold him. He has a rose in one hand and in the other a costly wand, from which depends over his right shoulder a wallet curiously embroidered. He is a prince of the other world on his travels through this one. He is the spirit in search of experience.

A. E. WAITE, *THE PICTORIAL KEY TO THE TAROT*, 1911

The white rose hangs stem down from his lowered hand, loose enough to drop. He is not carrying it anywhere, and he did not pick it himself. Somebody gave him that.

I promised you a second windfall, and this eighth house is where it comes from. It is not money — Temperance in your second already counted the money out, two sums, both of them yours.

So this one is free to arrive as a person's word instead.

Somebody inside your own circle says your name to him, and says it well, without being asked to. Hands you did not arrange, on an errand that was never yours.

That is why it moves your love life and not your bank balance. Nobody hands over a purse here — they hand over a sentence about you.

The Fool is not charging you with being naive, dear, or with stepping out unready. It shows a gift given before you thought to want it.

You decided, a while ago, that you would never ask anyone to speak for you.

what you believe

The celestial wisdom has guided your selection to the Hierophant, a card of waiting to be told you did it right



THE HIEROPHANT

*the proper way of doing it, and
what it costs to belong*

He wears the triple crown and is seated between two pillars, but they are not those of the Temple which is guarded by the High Priestess. In his left hand he holds a sceptre terminating in the triple cross, and with his right hand he gives the well-known ecclesiastical sign which is called that of esotericism, distinguishing between the manifest and concealed part of doctrine. At his feet are the crossed keys, and two priestly ministers in albs kneel before him. He has been usually called the Pope. He is the ruling power of external religion, as the High Priestess is the prevailing genius of the esoteric, withdrawn power. He symbolizes all things that are righteous and sacred on the manifest side.

A. E. WAITE, *THE PICTORIAL KEY TO THE TAROT*, 1911

Two men kneel below him in white robes, backs to us. We never see their faces. They are not being taught anything — they are waiting to be told they did it in the correct order.

You hold a belief you would deny if I said it plainly: that approval has to be granted to you by somebody with the standing to grant it. It cannot be taken. It has to be given, properly, in front of others.

Point at three things and you will find it. The person you check with before you decide anything that matters. The order you make yourself do things in when you want something.

The reason you give for having waited.

That is not carefulness, dear. It is a rule, and it is slower than your life.

The two keys are crossed on the floor at his feet. He has not handed them down to anyone.

Whose approval are you still waiting to be given?

Then the tenth house arrives and makes that rule look expensive.

your standing

Your choice has led you to the Empress, a card of a crop nobody has cut



THE EMPRESS

*something growing that needs
feeding, not starting*

A stately figure, seated, having rich vestments and royal aspect, as of a daughter of heaven and earth. Her diadem is of twelve stars, gathered in a cluster. The symbol of Venus is on the shield which rests near her. A field of corn is ripening in front of her, and beyond there is a fall of water. The sceptre which she bears is surmounted by the globe of this world. She is the inferior Garden of Eden, the Earthly Paradise. She is above all things universal fecundity and the outer sense of the Word. In another order of ideas, the card of the Empress signifies the door or gate by which an entrance is obtained into this life, as into the Garden of Venus.

A. E. WAITE, *THE PICTORIAL KEY TO THE TAROT*, 1911

The corn stands ripe in front of her, and not one stalk of it has been taken. Full ears, bent with their own weight, still in the field.

You are already thought well of. That grew while you were busy, and it is further on than you think.

What has not happened is the cutting. Nobody has said your name aloud in the room where the decisions get made, and you have never said it there either.

The Hermit in your fourth is the same hand at work. Indoors you hand things over already finished, with no one attached — and outside you do it exactly the same way.

This card feeds what is grown, provided you stand where it is counted. So take the next piece of praise, dear, and stop there. Do not pass it along to whoever helped, and do not cut it shorter. Modesty has nothing to do with it.

The sceptre stays up in her hand the whole time.

your circle

Your selection has fallen to the Devil, a card of a hold she helps hold



THE DEVIL

a hold you take part in, and get something from

The Horned Goat of Mendes, with wings like those of a bat, is standing on an altar. At the pit of the stomach there is the sign of Mercury. The right hand is upraised and extended. In the left hand there is a great flaming torch, inverted towards the earth. A reversed pentagram is on the forehead. There is a ring in front of the altar, from which two chains are carried to the necks of two figures, male and female, as if Adam and Eve after the Fall. Hereof is the chain and fatality of the material life. The figures are tailed, to signify the animal nature, but there is human intelligence in the faces, and he who is exalted above them is not to be their master for ever.

A. E. WAITE, *THE PICTORIAL KEY TO THE TAROT*, 1911

The torch is lit and turned down, the flame pointed at the ground beside that black block. It burns nothing and lights nobody. All the warmth in that group of yours is being spent at the floor.

Count the chains. Two necks, two chains, one ring — the whole thing hangs off a single fixture, and the loops are wide enough to lift off over the head.

So your circle is not the crowd. It is two people keeping one thing in place, and one of them is you.

The Wheel in your fifth is what pays for this. He is inside this group, and that is why you keep saying yes — you stay near the people who cost you, to stay in the room with him.

I am not telling you to drop anyone, dear.

The next time the one who always organises asks you for something, say no. Out loud, this week.

Keep the two men apart as you read on. The one standing in your eleventh is the arrival. The one in your twelfth is the man you already have, and his is the harder page.

what is being kept from you

And your twelfth card is Judgment, a card of being called up to answer



JUDGMENT

*something from your past calling
for an answer now*

The great angel is here encompassed by clouds, but he blows his bannered trumpet, and the cross as usual is displayed on the banner. The dead are rising from their tombs—a woman on the right, a man on the left hand, and between them their child, whose back is turned. But in this card there are more than three who are restored. It should be noted that all the figures are as one in the wonder, adoration and ecstasy expressed by their attitudes. It is the card which registers the accomplishment of the great work of transformation in answer to the summons of the Supernal—which summons is heard and answered from within. It has been called truly in the past a card of eternal life.

A. E. WAITE, *THE PICTORIAL KEY TO THE TAROT*, 1911

Further out on the water, past the three in front, more coffins stand open — small figures with their arms up, too far off for faces. The calling has already started out there, where you cannot see who is standing.

The man you are bound to has begun leaving. Not a face from before, returning at the wrong hour — the one still here, the one sitting behind the veil in your seventh.

It has begun in him and nowhere else yet. Nobody around you has seen it.

This stayed out of your sight for a plain reason. Your days run like the Magician in your sixth — four things on the table, all of them yours, both hands busy. A woman working that hard

hears nothing coming.

Facing the right direction is narrow, dear. You ask him the direct question, and you refuse a warm answer that answers nothing.

Say nothing and the news reaches you last, out of another woman's mouth, long after everybody involved already knew.

Add the twelve up and they say one thing about you.

You run your entire life on not saying the plain sentence. Not to him. Not in the room where you are counted. Not to the woman who always asks you for the favour.

Every card here is charging you for that silence, and the price has just gone up.

The order matters now. The word somebody speaks for you comes first, and it comes without your help. The arrival in your fifth follows it. Neither of those waits on you.

The direct question in your twelfth does wait on you. That is the condition of the other two, and Judgment is standing there with the far coffins already open — the calling began before anyone told you. Ask him late, and you meet the man in your fifth with both hands still tied.

Here is what changes, dear. You will be early to your own news for once, hearing things while they are still being decided rather than after they are settled.

The first of it shows inside five to seven days. Someone in your circle repeats a good sentence about you that came out of somebody else's mouth. Mark the day it happens.

I have dated your fifth house and no other room in this reading. An arrival is an event and lands on a day; a man's slow leaving does not, and I am not going to invent days for the rest of it.

Two months is when the movement starts, not when it is all finished. Some of these rooms will have opened inside a fortnight. The Hermit and the Hierophant are slow cards by nature, and slow is not the same as failing — women stop a few weeks short of the thing coming right.

This week, write down the second sum, the one still owed to you. Put the figure somewhere you walk past every day.

And now the second part, dear — this one is yours to keep

When you have read your twelve properly — all of them, more than once — there is a second thing I want to give you, and it costs you nothing but a minute a night.

I said in my letter that the difference is not whether things happen to you. It is whether they happen to you from behind.

This is the practice that makes the difference. It is the only one I give away.

What it is

Twenty-eight nights. One line a night. That is the whole of it.

Each night before you sleep, you write down **one thing you noticed that day that was different from the day before.**

Not how you felt. Not what you hope. What you *noticed*. Something someone said that they don't usually say. A message that came at an odd hour. A silence where there is normally noise. The way a room went when you walked into it.

One line. Ordinary handwriting, ordinary paper, no ceremony. If nothing was different, write *nothing was different* — that is a real entry and you will want it later.

The reason is simple and it is not mystical, dear. Your twelfth house is holding something unsaid, and things like that are never invisible. They are only ever *unrecorded*. A woman notices eleven small wrong notes across a fortnight, forgets ten of them, and is genuinely astonished by the eleventh. She was told eleven times. She just had nowhere to put it.

The ledger is somewhere to put it.

The four turns

Nights 1 to 7 — the first turn. Just notice. Don't interpret, don't join anything up, and above all don't act on it. This week you are only training the eye. Write the line and close the book.

Your reading said the first sign shows itself inside five to seven days. It lands in this turn. You will not necessarily know it when it arrives — that is exactly why you are writing it down.

Nights 8 to 14 — the second turn. Same one line, and add a second only when you genuinely have one. By now you will start wanting to explain what you're writing. Resist it for

one more week. An explanation written the same night is almost always the explanation you already believed that morning.

Night 15 — the read-back. This is the night the practice pays. Do not write anything first. Sit down and read your fourteen lines in one sitting, in order, start to finish.

Something will come up off the page that was not visible on any single night. It always does. That is the whole reason for the fourteen — not one of those lines is worth much alone and together they are a pattern.

Then write your line for the fifteenth night, and write underneath it what you saw in the fourteen.

Nights 15 to 21 — the third turn. Now you know what you have been noticing, so notice *that*. Your attention has something to point at, and you will find you catch things on the day now instead of three days late.

Nights 22 to 28 — the fourth turn. Keep writing, and this week let yourself act on what you have found. Ask the question. Decline the thing. Say the sentence you have been keeping. You have three weeks of evidence behind you and you are no longer guessing.

On the twenty-eighth night, read the whole ledger through.

The two love weeks

In the weeks your reading named, pay particular attention to the people you come across.

Your fifth house has something already in motion toward you, and your reading has said in its own room whether it arrives as a stranger or as someone already in the frame. Either way it comes in small — which is precisely the kind of thing the eye skips and the ledger catches.

Someone you know may reappear in these weeks. Someone in the frame may step forward in it. Write it down on the night, in the ordinary way, even when it seems far too small to mean anything.

Especially then. The ones that matter almost always look too small on the night.

If nothing happens

Then you run the twenty-eight again.

I mean that plainly and not as a consolation. Some women's first cycle is all noise — four weeks of *nothing was different* — and their second cycle is the one that shows the shape. The practice is not a spell that either works or doesn't. It is an eye being trained, and eyes take a while.

The second twenty-eight is easier than the first, and it is the one where the read-back on the fifteenth night stops you cold.

And that is the gift

Keep the book. Not for me — I don't want to see it, and I'd rather you wrote freely than wrote something you'd be willing to show a reader.

Keep it because in eight weeks you are going to want to know whether you saw it coming.

You did. It will be on the page in your own handwriting, three weeks before it happened, in a line you thought was too small to matter.

That is what it is to stop finding out last.

These twelve were laid for you and for nobody else. The writing is assisted — I use a machine to help me put a reading into words. The draw is real and it is yours.

Evelyn